

Question ID: 8705ecba

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Percentages	Easy

Question

The cost of a certain shirt is \$20 before a 5% sales tax is added. What is the total cost, including sales tax, to purchase the shirt?

Answer

- A. \$20.05
- B. \$20.50
- C. \$21.00
- D. \$25.00

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. The total cost to purchase the shirt is the \$20 cost of the shirt plus the 5% sales tax. The value of the 5% sales tax on the \$20 shirt is equivalent to $(0.05)(\$20)$, or \$1. Therefore, the total cost to purchase the shirt is $\$20 + \1 , or \$21.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from neglecting to multiply by \$20 when finding the value of the sales tax. Choice B is incorrect and may result from dividing by 10, instead of by 100, and then neglecting to multiply by \$20 when finding the sales tax. Choice D is incorrect and may result from interpreting the sales tax of 5% as \$5.